

- ▶ **Outlook:** Outlook provides the same functions on Macs as it does on PCs. The interface is easy-to-use and intuitive. You can synchronise your email from multiple accounts like Hotmail, Gmail, Yahoo! Mail, etc. The application lets you import your contacts, emails and to-do lists from your Windows installation of Outlook.

Perhaps, the only issue with Microsoft Office 2011 for Mac is that it doesn't integrate properly with Apple's other software such as iTunes.

Reasons to consider a paid solution

Before, the main reason that one would go for a paid solution was the innumerable number of features offered by them compared to free versions. But as the Open Source community grew stronger, the free office suites started closing in on paid office suites, which had to consolidate their strength in order to remain unique and profitable. Following are a few reasons that one should consider choosing between a paid and a free office suite.

Security

This should be one of the main points when considering an office suite. Since the code of open source software is free for everyone to see it's easy to exploit. Patches are often not on time, which could lead to security breaches. Vulnerabilities of the code are discussed freely on forums and could be exploited by hackers before the patch is released. Comparatively, paid software is more secure since the vulnerabilities are kept secret by the companies until a patch is released. Also, the patches are developed quicker as their very profits depend on the software's reputation. Then there are also comparatively more resources being dedicated by the company towards its software.

Support

This is the second most important point to consider when selecting an office suite. If you're considering an office suite for your company and your IT team is small or non-existent, then you'll definitely need proper support for your office application as it's an important part of your daily work. Paid office suites will generally have a good support structure, which could include any or all of the following

- ▶ Call centres
- ▶ Online resource
- ▶ Books
- ▶ Licensed vendors and professional consultants